AHEGS Advantage: Arc Activity Risk Management Form

For additional information on the risk management process including review requirements please refer to HS329 Risk Management Procedure

Activity name	**Fishing Society UNSW (FishSoc)**

Identify the activity and the location of the activity: Proposed scope: approved shore-based locations selected for each event. Before approval, insert the exact site, street address or map pin, meeting point, access route and nearest hospital for each activity.

Description of activity:	Beginner shore-fishing outings - Every outing requires a site-specific assessment and pre-event check. Do not proceed if the selected site, forecast or staffing arrangements do not allow the approved controls to be maintained.

Identify who may be at risk from the activity

The types of people may affect the risk controls needed and the location may affect the number of people at risk

Persons at risk:	UNSW student participants; any approved associate members; student event leads and volunteers; nearby members of the public; site/venue staff; and emergency responders.
How they were consulted on the risk:	Consultation is pending. Before submission, discuss the draft with the event leads and volunteers, seek participant or representative feedback, and consult Arc Clubs and the site contact. Record who was consulted, when, comments raised and any resulting changes.

	Name	Signature	Date

Form completed by	**Tenuun Temuujin**	**Tenuun**	**22/10/26**
Responsible supervisor/authorising officer Arc clubs – email form to clubs@arc.unsw.edu.au to review and sign			

Acknowledgement of understanding

Note: for activities which are low risk or include a large group of people (e.g. open days, BBQ's, student classes etc), only the persons undertaking the key activities need to sign below. For all others involved in such activities, the information can be covered by other methods including for example a safety briefing, induction, and/or safety information sheet (ensure the method of communicating this information is specified here)

I have read and understand this risk management form	**Name**	**Signature**	**Date**
	Tenuun Temuujin	Tenuun	22/10/26

Identify hazards and control the risks.

1. An activity may be divided into tasks. For each task identify the hazards and associated risks. Also list the possible scenarios which could sooner or later cause harm.
2. Determine controls necessary based on legislation, codes of practice, Australian standards, manufacturer's instructions, safety data sheets etc.
3. List existing risk controls and any additional controls that need to be implemented
4. Rate the risk once all controls are in place using the risk rating matrix

Feel free to resize the boxes to suit your situation/the amount of text you need to use

Task/ Scenario What activities are students participating in?	*Hazard* What are potential ways students could be harmed?	*Existing controls* What actions are you currently undertaking to minimise this risk?	*Any additional controls required?* Do the activity owners need to take further action to minimise risk?	*Risk Rating*		
				Consequences	*Likelihood*	*Risk*
Shore-based fishing and moving near water	Slips, falls, wave strike or falling into the water may cause serious injury, drowning or delayed rescue.	Planned controls to verify: use stable shore sites; no swimming, wading or boats; define a no-entry boundary; keep a buddy/headcount system; brief participants to stay behind the boundary and never attempt an in-water rescue.	Before each event, inspect the exact site and tide/swell conditions; identify emergency access and communications; appoint a go/no-go lead. Move or cancel if the boundary or safe access cannot be maintained.	*4*	*B*	*H*

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Outdoor activity in changing weather	Heat, UV, cold, wind, lightning or changing water conditions may cause heat illness, sunburn, hypothermia, falls or worsening water-edge risk.	Planned controls to verify: check conditions before travel; schedule away from extreme heat where practicable; tell participants to bring water, sun protection and suitable clothing; stop if conditions deteriorate.	Set and communicate written cancellation thresholds; check current forecasts and local warnings again on the day; name the person who can pause or cancel the session and send the cancellation message.	*2*	*C*	*M*
Casting, hooks, line and fishing tools	Hooks, sinkers, rods, scissors or knives may puncture or cut skin, injure eyes, strike another person or entangle a participant.	Planned controls to verify: keep hooks secured when not in use; demonstrate safe handling; establish casting zones and spacing; supervise beginners; do not leave sharp tools unattended.	Inspect the activity layout before casting; require participants to stop before people enter the casting zone; use a first-aid plan and kit appropriate to the assessed activity; do not use knives unless separately authorised and assessed.	*4*	*B*	*H*
Uneven, wet or restricted access at fishing sites	Slippery rock, steps, loose ground, poor lighting or an inaccessible route may cause falls, sprains or delayed assistance.	Planned controls to verify: select stable, well-lit shore access; share access and footwear information; walk the route before the event; avoid unstable edges and closed areas.	Record the meeting point, route, accessible alternative and nearest emergency access in the event assessment. Exclude areas that cannot be inspected or safely reached.	*4*	*B*	*H*

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				Consequences	*Likelihood*	*Risk*
Fish, marine life and biological contact	Spines, teeth, stings, bites, cuts, allergens or contact with contaminated water may cause injury, allergic reaction or infection.	Planned controls to verify: do not handle unknown or protected wildlife; demonstrate cautious handling; use tools rather than bare hands where suitable; wash hands after handling fish or equipment; follow current official guidance.	Brief participants on local species hazards; identify who will manage an injury response; consider participant needs confidentially and do not require anyone to handle a catch.	*3*	*C*	*H*
Carrying and setting up equipment	Lifting or carrying tackle boxes, rods and shared equipment may cause strains, dropped items or trips near the water edge.	Planned controls to verify: keep loads small; use a stable route and designated gear area; do not carry gear while moving through an active casting zone.	Check equipment quantity and weight before departure; use a trolley or team lift where suitable; assign pack-in/pack-out roles and keep paths clear.	*2*	*D*	*L*
Travel, separation or loss of communication	Participants may become separated, miss the return check or be unable to contact the event lead, delaying assistance. Club transport is outside this general scope.	Planned controls to verify: publish the meeting point and end time; use attendance and buddy checks; avoid isolated sites without reliable communications; participants arrange their own travel.	For each venue, test mobile coverage or set a backup communication plan; record check-in and return arrangements; complete a separate assessment before any group transport or remote trip.	*1*	*E*	*L*

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				Consequences	*Likelihood*	*Risk*
Behaviour, inclusion and privacy	Bullying, harassment, discrimination, exclusion, distress or unauthorised photography/data sharing may harm participants or discourage them from seeking help.	Planned controls to verify: set conduct expectations; identify the event and welfare contacts; provide an accessible way to raise concerns; collect only necessary data; ask consent before identifiable photos.	Brief the team on incident and grievance routes, privacy and photo consent; provide clear access information and a beginner buddy; store sign-up and incident records securely with restricted access.	*2*	*C*	*M*
Shoreline clean-up and discarded line	Discarded hooks, line, glass or unidentified waste may puncture or cut people; poor disposal may harm wildlife or the environment.	Planned controls to verify: only collect waste that can be handled safely; use suitable tools and puncture-resistant containers; do not handle sharps or unknown hazardous items; secure collected line for proper disposal.	Set a stop-and-report rule for sharps or hazardous waste; identify the site waste-disposal route; provide gloves/ tools only where suitable and brief participants on safe use.	*3*	*C*	*H*

RISK RATING METHODOLOGY AND MATRIX

Consider the Consequences

Consider: What type of harm could occur (minor, serious, death)? Is there anything that will influence the severity (e.g. proximity to hazard, person involved in task etc.). How many people are exposed to the hazard? Could one failure lead to other failures? Could a small event escalate?

5. Severe: death or permanent disability to one or more persons

4. Major: hospital admission required

3. Moderate: medical treatment required

2. Minor: first aid required

1. Insignificant: injuries not requiring first aid

Consider the Likelihood

Consider: How often is the task done? Has an accident happened before (here or at another workplace)? How long are people exposed? How effective are the control measures? Does the environment effect it (e.g. lighting/temperature/pace)? What are people's behaviours (e.g. stress, panic, deadlines) What people are exposed (e.g. disabled, young workers etc.)?

A. Almost certain: expected to occur in most circumstances

B. Likely: will probably occur in most circumstances

C. Possible: might occur occasionally

D. Unlikely: could happen at some time

E. Rare: may happen only in exceptional circumstances

Calculate the Risk

1.Take the consequences rating and select the correct column

2.Take the likelihood rating and select the correct row

3. Select the risk rating where the two ratings cross on the matrix below.

VH = Very high, H = High, M = Medium, L = Low

	CONSEQUENCES				
LIKELIHOOD	1	2	3	4	5
A	M	H	H	VH	VH
B	M	M	H	H	VH
C	L	M	H	H	VH
D	L	L	M	M	H
E	L	L	M	M	M

Risk level	Required action
Very high	**Act immediately:** The proposed task or process activity must not proceed. Steps must be taken to lower the risk level to as low as reasonably practicable using the hierarchy of risk controls
High	**Act today:** The proposed activity can only proceed, provided that: (i) the risk level has been reduced to as low as reasonably practicable using the hierarchy of risk controls and (ii) the risk controls must include those identified in legislation, Australian Standards, Codes of Practice etc. and (iii) the document has been reviewed and approved by the Supervisor and (iv) a Safe Working Procedure or Safe Work Method has been prepared.
Medium	**Act this week**: The proposed task or process can proceed, provided that: (i) the risk level has been reduced to as low as reasonably practicable using the hierarchy of controls and (ii) a Safe Working Procedure or Safe Work Method has been prepared.
Low	**Act this month:** Managed by local documented routine procedures which must include application of the hierarchy of controls.

Once completed the original form is to be kept locally and a copy uploaded to the AHEGS Advantage Activity Nomination Form for reference and audit purposes.

This RMF is to be reviewed as per the UNSW Risk Management procedure requirements, at least 3 yearly.